RESEARCH IN SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGICAL EDUCATION

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FROM THE ARCHIVE · 2005

Important but not for me: students' attitudes towards secondary school science in England

Edgar W. Jenkins and N. W. Nelson

University of Leeds, UK

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WHAT DID THIS PAPER CONTRIBUTE?

- Drawing on the international Relevance of Science Education (ROSE) project, Jenkins and Nelson analysed responses from 1,266 students in England.
- 68% agreed everyone should learn science at school and 61% found it interesting, yet only 21% wanted to become scientists.
- The article helped bring students' perspectives into debates on science curriculum reform.

Jenkins and Nelson (2005) · Research in Science & Technological Education · doi.org/10.1080/0263514050006843 5

WHAT HAS CHANGED, AND WHY IT MATTERS

- Students today meet science through smartphones, AI and climate debates, and science-based careers have broadened well beyond the lab.
- Yet one question remains: why do students value science without wanting to pursue it?
- The paper still asks how curricula can respond to students' interests while ensuring broad, equitable learning.

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